

Egyptian Ratscrew

Card Deck · 2 to 6 players · about 15 minutes

House rules written for The Game Room. These are the common rules; plenty of tables play their own variations, so agree on any before you start.

How to play

Deal out the whole deck face down; nobody looks at their cards. In turn, flip your top card onto the middle pile.

When an ace or face card is played, the next player gets a limited number of flips to play another ace or face card: 4 for an ace, 3 for a king, 2 for a queen, 1 for a jack. If they turn up an ace or face card in time, the challenge passes to the next player; if they fail, whoever played the last ace or face card takes the pile.

Anyone may slap the pile when the top two cards match in rank (a double) or when the top card matches the one two below it (a sandwich), and the first to slap takes the pile. A wrong slap costs a card under the pile. A player with no cards can still slap back in. Win by collecting every card.